

LEARN IT. APPLY IT. LOVE IT.

WORKING PAPER 6 · LEGIBILITY

THE LEGIBLE ORGANIZATION

How much legibility delegation needs — to
people as much as to systems.



ONE LAYER DEEPER.

"Verification walls do not yield to more effort at the layer where they appear — they yield to legibility at the layer beneath."

Buteau and Kommrusch turn the feeling of checking into a calculation: $d_E = T_{\text{train}} + T_{\text{task}}$ — the time to train an auditor, plus the time to produce a correct causal account of a particular behavior. Auditability under a budget B requires $d_E \leq B$.

Their stack has ten layers. Each answers a verification question of the layer above.

Buteau, T. & Kommrusch, S. (2026): Raman, not varelse — Why acceptably controllable AGI policies cluster around human-like stacks. AGI 2026, Part I, LNCS 16854, pp. 134–153. Springer.

TWO OUT OF FIVE.



OmegaClaw distinguishes five memory tiers of differing persistence and differing forgetting policy: working state, episodic trace, semantic memory, persistent symbolic structure, durable artifacts.

Each has its own job, and **none can substitute for another.**

Applied to organizations: most maintain **two out of five.** Semantic memory is rarely maintained, persistent structure almost never, artifacts rarely. That is the precise description of "the knowledge sits in people's heads".

Botnick, M., Hammer, P., Isaev, P., Goertzel, B. & Crawford, K. (2026): OmegaClaw — A continually operating agentic architecture under bounded resources. AGI 2026, Part I, LNCS 16854, pp. 338–353. Springer.

FIVE SILENT STORES.



With *Trace Fields*, Montes describes memory that does not sit in the agent but in the environment — **traces others can read**. Not as a metaphor, but as a coordination mechanism for distributed systems without a central authority.

The link to organizational research is immediate: Walsh and Ungson (1991) name six stores — people, culture, procedures, structures, the work setting, external archives. **Five of them are silent.**

A silent store contains everything and gives out nothing until someone asks the right question.

Montes, G. A. (2026): Trace fields as externalized memory — A stigmergic multi-agent simulation of distributed control and trace-ecology governance. AGI 2026, Part II, LNCS 16855, pp. 78–90. Springer. Plus Walsh & Ungson (1991) on organizational memory.

TEN MINUTES, THREE WEEKS

NOT TRUST. A VERIFICATION BUDGET.

You assess a proposal from your own field in ten minutes. The same proposal from an unfamiliar field costs you three weeks — or you accept it unexamined and **call that trust**.

The limit of delegation is therefore not trust. It is a verification budget.

Whoever cannot check does not trust. **They hope.**

SAME WORD. FIVE MEANINGS.

A group has integrated thirteen companies in four years. Each brought its own meeting formats, its own decision routes, its own terms. The word "approval" means something different in five of the thirteen.

The board demands tighter reporting lines. Epistemic distance does not fall as a result — **it rises**, because the same reports now come from thirteen codebooks.

For every proposal the reader must first reconstruct **which house it came from**.

WHAT A COMPANY RETAINS.

01

Working state — agenda, open points · usually present

02

Episodic trace — minutes, decision chains · rarely findable

03

Semantic memory — procedures, schemas · rarely maintained

04

Persistent structure — what counts as tested · **almost never**

05

Artifacts — templates others can use · rarely maintained

Tiers: Botnick et al. (2026), OmegaClaw, AGI 2026, Part I, LNCS 16854, pp. 338–353.
Mapping and state column: this working paper.

DELEGATION REACHES AS FAR AS THE VERIFICATION BUDGET.

Epistemic distance does not fall through more effort at the layer where it becomes apparent, but through **legibility at the layer beneath**. And what does not stand outside people's heads leaves with them.

Here lies the strength of LEAD21, and it is not small: **a common leadership language across all levels is nothing other than a reduction of T_{train}** . The auditor's training is paid once and holds for every later proposal.

Two places do not hold: what counts as tested is stored nowhere — the fourth memory tier is empty.

NEXT

SEND ME "LEADERSHIP".

as a direct message — and I will send you the working paper as a PDF. Free, no newsletter.

Gerald Huesch — developer of LEAD21, the Leadership OS. Has trained over 30,000 leaders in 30+ countries, including NASA and Rolls-Royce.

All eight papers: gerald-huesch.com/press-en